HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "A little doesn't count. I can keep it small and still be in control."

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"A little doesn't count. I can keep it small and still be in control." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What do I mean by a little, and has that meaning already changed?
- ☐ What am I unwilling to give up, even in a small amount?
- ☐ Would I want a friend to get help at this stage, or only after a crisis?
- ☐ Am I more interested in keeping it small or in telling the truth?
- ☐ What would help look like before things grow?
- ☐ What does "not mastered by anything" invite, without a speech of shame?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ A little can still matter. I can be honest about it, and I can get help before I have to prove I lost control.
- ☐ Small is not the same as harmless.
- ☐ I do not have to wait for a crisis to tell the truth.
- ☐ I am not worthless if a little has started to matter.
- ☐ I can ask whether this is mastering me.
- ☐ A doctor or a counselor can help me look at this without shaming me.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ 1 Corinthians 6:12
  "'Everything is permissible for me,' but not everything is beneficial. 'Everything is permissible for me,' but I will not be mastered by anything."
- ☐ Proverbs 27:1
  "Do not boast about tomorrow, for you do not know what a day may bring."
- ☐ Hebrews 4:16
  "Let us then approach the throne of grace with confidence, so that we may receive mercy and find grace to help us in our time of need."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] When you said a little did not count: Each day, write down one moment when you kept the amount small in order to stay in control. Write what happened, what you told yourself, and one more accurate statement.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, 1 Corinthians 6:12 becomes: "James can write: "A little can still master me. I can tell the truth and ask for help.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Thinking, Healthy" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio or the Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If this belief comes with hopelessness or thoughts of ending your life, call or text 988 (the Suicide & Crisis Lifeline), or call 911 in an emergency. For help with substance use, call 1-800-662-4357, and talk with a doctor before you stop if withdrawal could make you sick.

- [ ] Write the actual amount for the last seven days, plainly. No comparing it with someone worse, and no name-calling.
- [ ] Show that note to a doctor, a counselor, or tell it to 1-800-662-4357.
- [ ] Do not "prove it is small" by stopping suddenly if withdrawal could make you sick. Ask what is safe.
- [ ] Pray 1 Corinthians 6:12 as a request not to be mastered, not as a verdict.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie "A little doesn't count. I can keep it small and still be in control.": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A time I did not minimize the amount
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~A little doesn't count. I can keep it small and still be in control~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I have said a little does not count. Give me honesty without shame, and help before this masters me. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.